City of Westminster

Council Agenda

Title:	**Council Meeting**
Meeting Date:	**Wednesday 12th November, 2025**
Time:	**7.00 pm**
Venue:	**Westminster Council House, 97-113 Marylebone Road, London, NW1 5PT**
Members:	**All Councillors are hereby summoned to attend the Meeting for the transaction of the business set out.**

In line with legislation Committee members will attend the meeting in person. This meeting will be live streamed through the Council's website.

Limited admission to the public gallery is available from 6.30pm. Please telephone if you are attending the meeting in a wheelchair or have difficulty walking up steps. There is wheelchair access via the Sammy Ofer Centre.

If you require any further information, please contact the Committee Officer, Janis Best, Strategic Lead - Committees and Councillors.

Email: jbest@westminster.gov.uk Tel: 07971 920521
Corporate Website: www.westminster.gov.uk

1. APPOINTMENT OF RELIEF CHAIR

To appoint a relief Chair.

2. MINUTES **(Pages 5 - 8)**

To sign the Minutes of the Council meeting held on 10 September 2025.

3. LORD MAYOR'S COMMUNICATIONS **(Pages 9 - 12)**

To receive the Lord Mayor's communications.

4. DECLARATIONS OF INTEREST

5. STATEMENT ON URGENT MATTERS

6. COUNCILLOR PRESENTED PETITIONS AND DEPUTATIONS, IF ANY

7. PUBLIC PARTICIPATION

The Lord Mayor will invite members of the public who have been chosen to present their question or petition. After which the relevant Cabinet Member or Committee Chair will respond.

8. QUESTIONS

The Lord Mayor will call Members who have indicated that they wish to ask a question after the Leader of the Opposition has asked their questions.

9. COUNCILLOR ISSUE

Councillor Ed Pitt Ford – 'The importance of choosing the right domestic heating systems within Pimlico and why this matters for current residents and generations to come.'

10. PARTY BUSINESS

11. REPORT TO FULL COUNCIL: CONSTITUTIONAL UPDATE - LONDON SQUARES PRESERVATION ACT 1931 **(Pages 13 - 18)**

To receive, consider and debate, if chosen, the following report which contains recommendations to the Council for approval and

adoption.

12. REPORT TO FULL COUNCIL: PROGRAMME OF MEETINGS 2026/2027 **(Pages 19 - 22)**

To receive, consider and debate, if chosen, the following report which contains recommendations to the Council for approval and adoption.

13. NOTICE OF MOTION

Standing united against the rise of the far right and in support of inclusive communities

To be moved by Cllr Adam Hug and seconded by Cllr Ryan Jude

This Council notes:

- The deeply worrying rise in far-right activity, anti-migrant language, and hate incidents across the country, and the impact these have had on our communities here in Westminster.
- Westminster has always been one of the most diverse and welcoming places in the world. People from more than 180 nationalities live here, speaking over 150 languages. Our city's strength comes from that diversity and from the contributions of those who have made Westminster their home to build our shared community.
- From the long-established Irish, Jewish and Caribbean communities in areas like Maida Vale, Harrow Road and Church Street, to newer communities from Bangladesh, Somalia, Morocco and across the Arab world, including Kurdish and Iraqi residents around Edgware Road, Westminster's culture and identity are shaped and enriched by people from every background and part of the world.
- The welcome progress the Council has made in becoming a more diverse and inclusive employer.

This Council believes:

- That migrant and minority communities have increasingly been targeted by divisive and misleading political rhetoric, often used to exploit hardship and drive wedges between people.
- That Westminster, like the rest of the country, faces serious challenges: a cost-of-living crisis, high housing costs, and years of underfunding of public services. But blaming migrants does not solve these problems. It only spreads fear and distracts from the real issues.
- That Westminster residents with indefinite leave to remain and settled status make hugely important contributions to

our community and our city. It would be a disgraceful departure from the values of our city to seek to deport our friends and neighbours with ILR or Settled Status if they happen to earn below £38,700 or if they or their dependents (including British citizens) have ever claimed any form of state support or have ever lived in council housing.

- That residents, community groups and faith leaders across Westminster continue to work hard to bring people together and promote understanding.

This Council therefore resolves to:

1. Reaffirm Westminster City Council's unwavering and full commitment to tackling racism and discrimination in all its forms, and to be leading by example to create a more inclusive council and community, building on the 2023 Anti-Racist Organisation and Borough of Sanctuary commitments amongst other policies.
2. Work closely with local partners and communities affected by hate or discrimination to ensure that council support is visible, consistent, and responsive to local needs.
3. Establish a cross-community working group, including residents, community representatives, youth voices, and faith leaders, to share experiences and understanding that develops practical community-led strategies.
4. Champion and promote local initiatives that celebrate Westminster's diversity and bring people together, including cultural festivals, interfaith gatherings, and youth programmes.
5. Condemn unequivocally all forms of racism, xenophobia, Islamophobia, antisemitism, and far-right extremism, and continue to work with the police and community partners to ensure related crimes are tackled swiftly and victims are treated with dignity and respect.
6. Reaffirm Westminster's commitment to remaining a safe, inclusive, and welcoming city where everyone, regardless of background or belief, can feel proud. To this end the council will deliver a new Community Equality Strategy focused on improving council services to ensuring earlier support is given and strengthening its role in promoting community cohesion.

64 Victoria Street
London, SW1E 6QP
4 November 2025

Chief Executive